

Yi-Chen Li (Ethan)

National Taiwan University • Taipei City, Taiwan

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SUMMARY

Self-motivated and disciplined master's student in Economics at National Taiwan University (NTU) with a strong foundation in mathematics, applied econometrics, and programming languages (R & Stata). Keen to pursue a PhD program in Economics or Political Science, with broad interest in international trade, political economy, applied econometrics, and philosophy.

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

Visiting Student

Berkeley, USA

2024/9 – 2025/5

- Funded by *Study Abroad Programme for Future Scholars in the Humanities and Social Sciences* from Ministry of Education, Taiwan.

National Taiwan University

M.A., Economics

Taipei, Taiwan

2023/9 – present

B.A., Economics (double major) & Political Science (Political Theory Division)

2018/9 – 2023/7

- Ranked 1/47 with average GPA 4.08.
- Awarded dean's list awards of political science dept. in 5 semesters.

SKILLS AND SELECTED COURSES

R (Main): Data Manipulation (dplyr, stringr, lubridate, etc.), Data Visualization (ggplot2), R Markdown.

Stata & $\LaTeX$

Selected Courses at UCB

- PhD Required Metric Theory (A):** Instructed by Prof. Michael Jansson and Prof. Bryan Graham, the course introduced the projection interpretation of OLS and asymptotic theory, followed by an exploration of Bayesian approaches such as decision theories, K-normal means, shrinkage methods, and the Bayesian Bootstrap.
- PhD Applied Econometrics (A):** Instructed by Prof. Kirill Borusyak, the course explored cutting-edge research designs and causal inference methods, including staggered adoption Diff-in-Diff, formula IV, double ML, etc.
- Other PhD Elective Courses:** Political Economics (Francesco Trebbi) and Spatial Economics (Cecile Gaubert and Mathilde Muñoz).

Selected Courses at NTU

- Graduate Core Courses:** Metric Theory (A+/A+), Micro Theory (A-/A+), Macro Theory (A/A+)
- Real Analysis I&II:** A+ / A (textbook: Rudin, 1976; Marsden & Hoffman, 1993).
- Statistics with Recitation (A+), Applied Statistics (A- / A+), Introductory Econometrics (A+)**
- Introduction to Statistical Learning (A+):** This course covered common statistical learning methods implemented with R, including regularization methods, cross-validation, classification models, etc.
- Machine Learning and Causal Inference (A+):** This course included the latest applications of machine learning in causal inference, such as doubly robust estimation, double lasso selection, and causal forest, etc.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Institute of Economics, Academia Sinica.

2022/8 – present

Pre-doctoral Fellow & Research Assistant to Research Fellow *Tzu-Ting Yang*

Taipei, Taiwan

- Constructed shift-share variables of imports from China to Taiwan with trade and regional industry data.
- Employed long differencing regression to analyze the effect of China Shock on Taiwan economy and political outcomes.
- Conducted literature review regarding shift-share design and IV strategy.
- Cleaned and constructed the administrative housing and insurance data from the ministry of finance.
- Generated summary statistics and graphs to explore the effect of housing transaction tax reform on housing market.

National Taiwan University

2023/7 – 2023/8 & 2024/2 – 2024/9

Research Assistant to Prof. *Ziho Park* and Chicago Fed Economist *Gustavo de Souza*

Taipei, Taiwan

- Cleaned and merged US firm level datasets.
- Organized and collected thousands of CVs of Brazil researchers.
- Constructed panel data of Brazil's researchers' academic activities from their CV.
- Applied Diff-in-Diff to analyze the effect of innovation subsidy on researchers' academic outcomes.

Causal Inference Workshop, Dept. of Economics at National Taipei University

2022/7

Participant

Taipei, Taiwan

- Studied major topics in Causal Inference, including potential outcome framework, DD, and RDD, from basic theories, recent developments, to coding skills in stata.

Institute for Information Industry (III).

2021/7 – 2021/9

Research Assistant at Market Intelligence & Consulting Institute (MIC)

Taipei, Taiwan

- Collected and summarized foreign governments' industrial policies (e.g. Smart Healthcare).
- Assisted the analysts in drafting Taiwan's national white paper for intelligent display industry.

PROJECTS

The Effect of Political Uncertainty on the Housing Market: 2020 Mayor Recall Election in Kaohsiung City | [Link](#)

- **Advisor:** Prof. [Jian-da Zhu](#)
- **Grant:** College Student Research Scholarship from the National Science Council (reviewed by anonymous scholars), **ranked A (top 20%)** among social science and humanity applicants.
- **Award:** College Student Research Creativity Award. (the top 200 projects out of 3,539 submissions with the above grant.)
- **Summary:** In 2020 Mayor Recall Election in Kaohsiung City, many news articles showed hesitation of the agents in the housing market, so I estimate the effect of this “political uncertainty” on the market, through a Diff-in-Diff identification strategy. I found that the transaction quantity dropped at the timing expected in my hypotheses whereas the price did not.

The Effect of Economic Freedom on Income Inequality (Term Paper for Intro. to Statistical Learning) | [Link](#)

- **Summary:** I use several statistical learning methods, such as Lasso and VIF, to investigate the “best” economic freedom variables (low multicollinearity and large coefficients) that can “explain” the variation of inequality (Gini index).

Misc

- **Languages:** English (fluent), Mandarin (native), Taiwanese Hokkien (native).